

Skill Assessment for Hands-On Lab: Product Manager Skills and Competency Checklist				
Product Manager Skills, Competencies, Techniques, or Required Areas of Expertise	Definition	Went Well	Can Be Improved	Justification
Abstract Thinking	The ability to look beyond the immediate problem or issue and envision a more holistic view.			Larry facilitated concept meetings early on with a well-structured agenda and a long-term perspective, showing his ability to think beyond the immediate tasks and envision strategic value and market positioning (e.g., niche for rapid synching).
Analysis Skills	A general management skill. Analyze and use reliable data to make educated and focused product decisions.			Larry initially failed to clearly communicate ROI and IRR during financial discussions. He had to rely on a financial SME later, showing a gap in his analytical depth regarding financial metrics.
Analytical Skills	Know how to use the data you can access to address issues and develop solutions that ultimately lead to a successful product launch.			Larry applied the Porter Five Forces Model with Ram to identify a niche, showing good competitive and market analysis to find product differentiation (rapid synching).
Analytical Thinking	Allows a Product Manager to create a sense of order, stay organized, communicate effectively across cross-functional teams, and make logical and rational decisions.			Larry was able to reprioritize product features under pressure and help finalize the prototype.
Attention to Detail	An organizational skill. Be able to understand specific activities that must be accomplished and organize the product team in a manner where they do things right.			Planning phases missed critical supplier and pricing data, impacting the financials and delivery timeline.
Brain Writing	A technique where participants are given an opportunity to think about questions that will be asked prior to the brainstorming session. These ideas are documented on paper, sticky notes, or even electronically to be shared or discussed.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Brainstorming	Allows a group to share ideas and opinions in a manner that enables the generation of multiple new ideas and thoughts about a subject in a short time.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Business Acumen	The ability to understand and manage various business situations.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Business Skills	A general management skill. Ensure value and Return on Investment (ROI) are achieved. Manage cash flow and calculate financial metrics.			Larry struggled to justify ROI and IRR until a financial SME supported him.
Collaboration	A process through which a group of people constructively explore their ideas to search for a solution that extends one's own limited vision.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Communications Skills	A general management skill. Regularly share ideas and convey objectives and priorities in an easy-to-understand manner.			Larry effectively set expectations, created agendas, and ensured stakeholders were prepared for meetings. These are signs of strong proactive communication throughout conceptualization and planning.
Core Benefit Identification	One of Kotler's Five Levels of a Product. Products and services that have the features or functionality to satisfy a customer's basic wants and needs.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Customer Empathy Identification	The ability to put yourself in the "customer's shoes." Understand the customers' needs and wants.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Decision-Making	Ability to come to a decision quickly and begin to take action on that decision immediately. Avoid analysis paralysis.			During the battery issue and feature prioritization, Larry and the team suffered from decision gridlock and analysis paralysis. He had to backtrack and re-prioritize features, showing reactive rather than proactive decision-making.
Delegation	An organizational skill. Identify all required activities, determine who is best suited to accomplish each activity, assign realistic and clear roles and responsibilities, and control and monitor results.			Larry tried to handle both product and project management tasks, which led to delays—better delegation could have reduced overload.
Delphi Technique	A facilitation method where ideas and information can be gained from a panel of experts using surveys or alternative methods. In many cases, anonymity of inputs is maintained.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Differentiation Analysis	Strategy to deal with Porter's Five Forces. Share how your product differs from other products. Highlight functionality or features you offer that the competition can't match.			Larry and Ram used Porter's Five Forces to identify a unique feature (rapid synching), successfully differentiating the product.
Elevator Pitch Development	A standard six-sigma tool used to tell a product story in an accurate, brief, and concise manner. Often used to develop a Product Vision.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Engineering Awareness	Help develop technical solutions to enhance product effectiveness and functionality.			The battery life issue being overlooked suggests a disconnect between product goals and technical constraints.
Facilitation	Enables people to get together to achieve a common goal and directs their focus and attention in ways that serve the group itself.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Focus identification	Strategy to deal with Porter's Five Forces. Try to find a niche. Look for features and functionality that no competitor can provide.			The team identified a lucrative niche within the smartwatch market—fast synching—showing clear niche targeting.
Ideation	The generation of new ideas.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Influencing	Motivating people to do what you need them to do.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Innovation	The execution of a new or improved product, process, marketing method, or organizational method in business practices, workplace organization, or external relations.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Market Segmentation Expertise	A marketing strategy that divides consumers into groups based on their needs, interests, behavior or demographics.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Marketing Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Innovation to achieve effective product design, packaging, promotion, and pricing .			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Marketing Skills	A general management skill. Promote and deliver products and services in the most efficient and successful ways possible.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Messaging	The way you communicate the value of your product to customers.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Multi-Tasking Ability	An organizational skill. Be aware of the "Two Hat Syndrome." Break out your activities, try to focus on the most critical product management related tasks, and delegate when you can.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Nominal Group Technique	Ideas are discussed and annotated. Each participant then is asked to rank each idea to aid in prioritization.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Organizational Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Planning and executing new methods to develop or improve an organization's business practices, workplace organization, and external relations .			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.

Primary Research Ability	Going to actual or potential customers in order to gain first-hand data or information. Primary research allows you to target your actual questions to the desired segment.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Prioritization Skills	A general management skill. Ensure that all team members are contributing to the most important tasks and using their time appropriately.			Larry reprioritized features during development to ensure delivery of a prototype on time.
Problem Solving	Allows a Product Manager to identify a problem, potential causes, identify root causes, and develop practical solutions.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Process Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Innovation to accomplish common goals that include faster delivery, less waste, and optimizing use of resources.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Product Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Innovation essential when introducing a product or service with features and functionality that are new or improved.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Product Management Expertise	The process of conceiving, planning, developing, testing, launching, delivering, and withdrawing products.			Larry managed the full lifecycle—from concept to delivery—despite challenges, indicating overall PM competency.
Product Roadmap Development	A high-level visual summary that maps out the vision, direction, priorities, and progress of a product over time.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Radical Innovation Planning	Radical innovation proposes large changes to the existing product landscape. It aims to plan and implement large improvements by redefining the product.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Research Skills	A general management skill. Ensure all decisions are based on sound data and logic. Use primary and secondary research techniques effectively.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Retrospective Facilitation	Inspect work that was completed, recommend changes, and adapt processes and behavior in ways to improve performance in the next Sprint.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Search Engine Optimization (SEO) Leadership	The art of making your website more visible and relevant to people who search online for products or services related to your business.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Secondary Research Ability	A method of collecting information that relies on indirect methods such as published reports, public or commercial databases, websites, agencies, surveys, and so on.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Self-Motivation	An organizational skill. Set singular goals that add the most value and accomplish them one at a time. Mentally reward yourself when things go well and remain optimistic in light of challenges.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
SMART Goal Development	Goals that are specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound.			Bethany created vague, non-measurable goals which slowed progress. This indicates a gap in clear, SMART-aligned goal-setting.
Storytelling	Helps the Product Manager create a compelling vision for their products by putting them in a larger context.			
Strategic Thinking	A general management skill. Understand the market and decide how to launch a new product effectively.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Strategy	Envisioning a desired outcome, charting an efficient course to achieve this objective, and aligning to that course as long as it makes sense to do so.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
SWOT Analysis	An analysis tool that stands for strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats. This is an appropriate tool to help guide business development objectives.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Technical Expertise	A general management skill. Ensure the product meets end-user expectations regarding its function, design and user experience.			Not clearly demonstrated or not mentioned in the scenario.
Time Management	An organizational skill. Work within tight deadlines set by management and customers alike. They must be able to establish realistic schedules and manage the team to achieve all key milestones and deliverable requirements.			Larry's final delivery met management's milestones and followed a realistic schedule. He effectively managed timelines, especially under pressure, to deliver the prototype and meet expectations.
Working Under Pressure	An organizational skill. Breakdown large projects into smaller and more understandable steps. Stay organized and focus on the most important tasks. Don't get lost in the details. Do not procrastinate and avoid dysfunctional conflict as much as possible.			Despite a high-pressure environment, Larry created a Work Breakdown Structure (WBS), broke large tasks into smaller ones, and maintained team focus. This shows strong resilience and structure under pressure.